

still be very difficult for Black to win as his extra pawn is the backward one on d6.

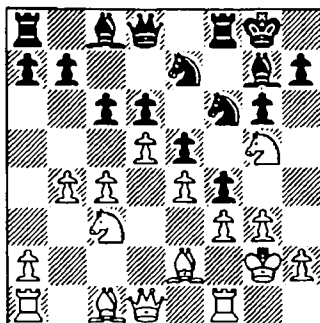


Diagram 2

Preventing a later Nc3-d5

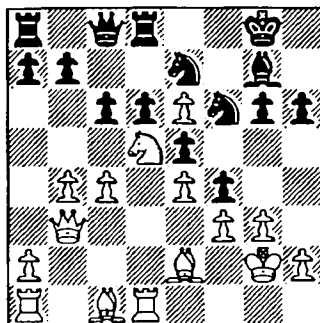


Diagram 3

White plays Nd5 anyway!

2) 14 c5 is very aggressive and probably best met by 14...h6 as on 15 Ne6 Bxe6 16 dxe6 Black can play 16...d5!. Instead, 15 Bc4! leads to a very complex game.

14...h6

When Black feels he is ready for Ne6 he plays this move; otherwise he just keeps on improving his position.

15 Ne6 Bxe6 16 dxe6 Qc8 17 Rd1 Rd8

Exercise 4: Why didn't Black play 17...Qxe6?

18 Nd5!? (Diagram 3)

White was faced with the choice of letting his e6-pawn go for insufficient compensation or sacrificing a piece to ensure that it survives for the rest of the game. This sacrifice is known from similar positions but normally White gets more direct play than he does here.

18...cxd5 19 cxd5 g5

It is very hard to believe that White has enough for the piece. Van Wely has assessed this position as unclear but he didn't repeat it. Still, as the game shows, it is not easy for Black to make progress.

20 Bd2 Rf8 21 g4 h5 22 h3 Ng6 23 Rdc1 Qb8 24 Be1 hxg4 25 hxg4 Ne8 26 a4 Bf6 27 a5 Bd8 28 Qa4 Nf6 29 Ra3 Kg7 30 Bf2 Rh8 31 Rac3 Be7 32 Rc7 Rh6 33 Qa1 Qh8 34 Rh1 Nxg4!? 35 fxg4 f3+ 36 Bxf3 Nf4+ 37 Kg1 Rxh1+?

Black got fed up with all the quiet manoeuvring and sacrificed a piece for an attack. However, it is only good enough for a draw. Fedorov should have contented himself with perpetual check: 37...Ne2+! 38 Kg2 (38 Bxe2 Rxh1+) 38...Nf4+ 39 Kg1 Ne2+.

38 Bxh1 Qh3 39 Qd1 Rh8 40 Rxe7+ Kg6 41 Bf3 Qh2+ 42 Kf1 Rc8

43 Rf7 Qh3+ 44 Kg1 Rc3 45 Rxf4 gxf4 46 Bg2

White has a decisive advantage although the game was eventually drawn on move 87.

... Draw agreed

Game 21

□ Kamsky ■ Kasparov

New York Intel (rapid) 1994

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Nf3 0-0 6 Be2 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 b4 Nh5 10 c5 Nf4

This is the main line. 10...h6 and 10...f5 are also played from time to time.

11 Bxf4 exf4 12 Rc1

Not only has White given up his strong bishop but he has also opened the long diagonal for Black's bishop. He hopes to justify his play by removing all his pieces from this diagonal, leaving Black's bishop pointing at thin air. He will also be looking to use the d4-square for his knights now that Black no longer has a pawn on e5. Occasionally White defends the knight with his queen and against both 12 Qb3 and 12 Qd2. Black's best strategy is then to play ...Bg4xf3 in order to assume control of e5.

12...a5!?

More common is 12...h6 followed by ...g6-g5 and ...Ng6, but this is a good moment to challenge White's supremacy on the queenside. The main points in favour of the immediate 12...a5 are that it develops the rook on a8 and that Garry Kasparov plays it!

13 cxd6

A more solid continuation is 13 a3.

13...cxd6 14 Nb5

White is willing to give up his pawn on b4 in order to get a rook to the 7th rank.

14...Bg4 15 Rc7 axb4 16 Qd2

16 Qb3 can also be met by 16...Bxf3 with similar play.

16...Bxf3! (Diagram 4) 17 Bxf3 Be5 18 Rxb7!?

This has been played a couple of times but I would prefer 18 Rfc1.

18...Qa5 19 Nd4 Qxa2 20 Qxa2 Rxa2 21 Rxb4 Rfa8 22 Bg4!?

After 22 Nc6 Nxc6 23 dxc6 Rc2 White will lose his passed pawn but can at least activate his bishop by 24 Bd1 Rxc6 25 Bb3. Perhaps Black should have played 21...Bxd4 to avoid this.

22...Bxd4 23 Rxd4 g5

Black now threatens to achieve a strategically won game by the manoeuvre ...Ng6-e5. White could have played 24 Bh5 to prevent ...Ng6 but then Black would have calmly improved his position with ...Rb8

and ...Kg7-f6. Kamsky decides to allow the knight into e5 and instead pins his hopes on breaking up the black pawn structure. With best play the position may be a draw but it is very unpleasant to defend.

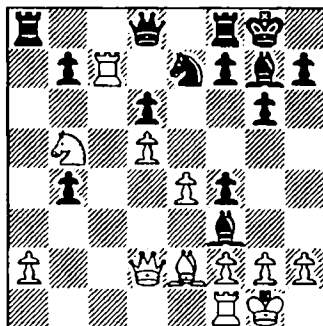


Diagram 4

Taking control of the dark squares

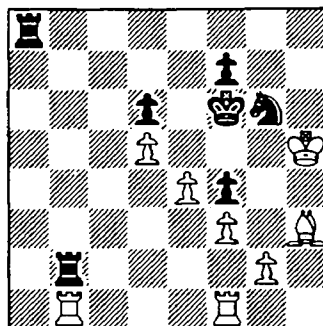


Diagram 5

The white king is in trouble

24 h4 gxh4 25 Kh2 Ng6 26 Kh3 Rb2 27 Bf5 Ne5 28 Kxh4 h6 29 Bh3 Kg7 30 Rdd1 Raa2 31 f3 Ng6+ 32 Kg4 Kf6 33 Rb1 h5+!

Suddenly the white king finds itself in a mating net.

34 Kxb5 Ra8! (Diagram 5) 35 Kg4

If 35 Rxb2 Rh8+ 36 Kg4 Rh4 mate.

35...Rh8 36 g3 Rh2

White stopped the mate but at the cost of his bishop.

37 Rh1 R8xh3 38 Rxh2 Rxh2 39 gxf4 Rg2+ 40 Kh3 Nxf4+ 41 Kh4 Ke5 42 Rb7 Kd4 43 Rxf7 Ke3 White resigns

The Bayonet 9 b4: The Main Line 10 Re1

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Nf3 0-0 6 Be2 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 b4 Nh5 10 Re1 (Diagram 6)

What is the point of 10 Re1?

The simple idea behind 10 Re1 is to meet 10...Nf4 with 11 Bf1. The bishop on f1 is very well placed defensively and it turns out that, despite its active appearance, the knight on f4 is actually quite poorly placed. There is nothing for it to attack and it can even get in the way of Black's kingside play. Black will also have to be constantly on the lookout for White playing Bxf4 at a favourable moment.

It took quite a while, and cost an awful lot of points, before Black players appreciated all this. Meanwhile, everyone was playing 9 b4. The old main lines, 9 Ne1 and 9 Nd2, just disappeared. The results

went overwhelmingly in White's favour. However, the tide finally appears to be turning. The main problem for Black was not the strength of 10 Re1, but the fact that he was playing too ambitiously. The King's Indian attracts players who are looking for a sharp struggle. Instead of trying to prove equality they were trying to destroy the Bayonet Attack. They didn't realise that the best way to destroy the Bayonet Attack is to prove equality! Once equality has been established, white players are bound to turn their attention elsewhere. This has been happening over the last year or so and we are beginning to see a bit less of the Bayonet Attack and a bit more of other variations in the King's Indian.

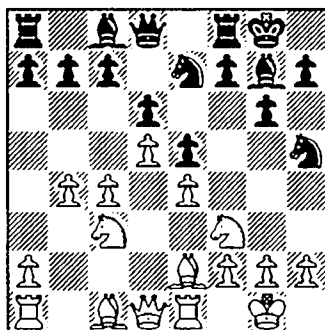


Diagram 6
The mysterious 10 Re1

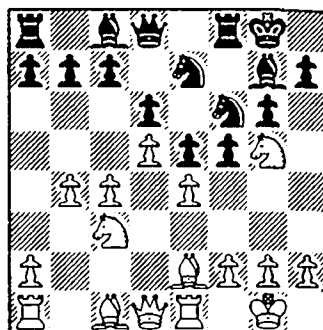


Diagram 7
The knight retreats

10...f5

There is no need for Black to commit himself to ...Nf4 (although this is examined in Game 22). Instead, he looks at the move ...Nh5 in the same way he would look at ...Ne8 or ...Nd7 – as a means of clearing the way for Black's traditional King's Indian advance ...f7-f5

11 Ng5

This is the critical test and the move that originally put many Black players off playing 10...f5. As in the line with 10 g3, the knight is heading for e6.

11...Nf6! (Diagram 7)

White was threatening 12 Bxh5 so the knight had to move. 11...Nf4 has also been played but it is less reliable than the text (12 Bxf4 exf4 13 Rc1 appears to favour White). From f6 the knight exerts more influence on the centre. Now White has two ways to defend his centre. In Games 23 and 24 we see 12 Bf3 while Game 25 deals with 12 f3.

Theoretical?

Extremely.

Statistics

Grim reading for Black. White has scored 62% in just over 900 games with 10 Re1. Not so many games but remember this variation only started a few years ago. Black does a bit better when he plays with 10...f5 and 11...Nf6 but White still scores a healthy 58%

Illustrative Games

Game 22

□ Kobalija ■ Smirnov

Russian Championship, Elista 2001

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Nf3 0-0 6 Be2 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 b4 Nb5 10 Re1 Nf4 11 Bf1 a5!? 12 bxa5 Rxa5 13 a4 c5

13...f5 can be played at once as 14 Bxf4 exf4 15 e5 dxe5 16 Nxe5 is not so good now because of the reply 16...Qd6!. White usually meets 13...f5 with 14 Nd2 and several games have continued 14...fxe4 15 Ndx4 Nf5 16 Nb5! with advantage to White.

14 Nb5 Ra6 15 Ra3! Nh5

A rather sad retreat. Black wants to play ...f7-f5 but can't because of the usual 16 Bxf4 exf4 17 e5. An alternative strategy is to play 15...h6 followed by ...g6-g5 and only then ...f7-f5 but numerous games have shown this is also insufficient for equality.

16 g3 Kh8 17 Nh4! Ng8

White's last two moves have been designed to prevent ...f7-f5, e.g 17...f5? 18 exf5 Nxf5 19 Nxf5 Bxf5 20 g4 and White wins a piece.

18 Ng2 Nhf6 19 Bb2 Nd7 20 Qa1 (Diagram 8)

White is preparing to play f2-f4!. His pieces have more scope so it makes sense for him to open the position.

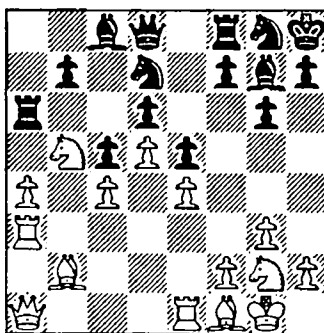


Diagram 8

Preparing to open up with f2-f4

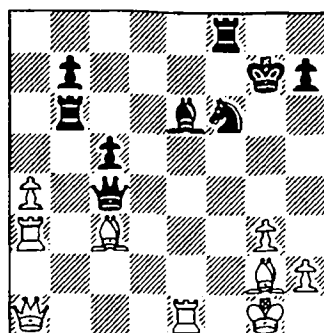


Diagram 9

The long diagonal pin is decisive

Starting Out: The King's Indian

20...f5?!

Black should have stayed passive with 20 Nf6 21 f4 f6. It won't be much fun but at least he won't get blown away in the centre.

21 exf5 gxf5 22 f4!

Now there is nothing Black can do to prevent the sacrifice on d6

22...Ne7 23 Nxd6! Rxd6 24 fxe5 Rb6 25 Bc3!

White wants to play e6 so he must first move his bishop.

25...Ng6 26 e6 Nf6 27 Nh4! Ne7 28 Bh3 Nxd5?!

Returning the material is hopeless because White is able to take the bishop on g7 and catch Black in a deadly pin on the long diagonal.

29 cxd5 Qxd5 30 Bg2 Qc4 31 Nxf5 Bxc6 32 Nxc7 Kxc7 (Diagram 9) 33 a5! Rd6 34 Ra4 Qd3 35 Rf4 Bd5 36 Rg4+ Kf7 37 Bxf6 Rxf6 38 Qe5?!

38 Qb1! was a quicker and more elegant way to win. The point is that after 38...Qxb1 White doesn't recapture but flicks in 39 Bxd5+.

38...Qd2 is also impossible on account of 39 Qxh7 mate.

38...Be6 39 Qh5+ Ke7 40 Qxc5+ Qd6 41 Rg7+ R8f7 42 Rxf7+ Rxf7 43 Qd5 Qd7 44 Qxb7 Black resigns

Game 23

□ Babula ■ Degraeve

Istanbul Olympiad 2000

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Nf3 0-0 6 Be2 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 b4 Nh5 10 Re1 f5 11 Ng5 Nf6! 12 Bf3

White defends his centre with pieces and envisages that his bishop on f3 will become active when the long diagonal opens. He can also defend his centre with a pawn move. 12 f3 is the subject of Game 25.

12...c6 (Diagram 10)

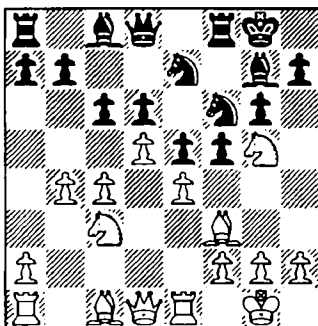


Diagram 10

A safer approach for Black

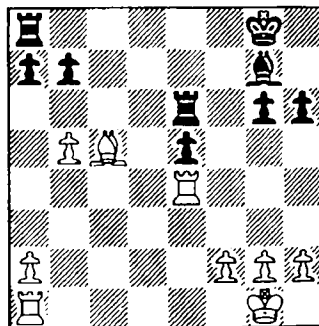


Diagram 11

Black is OK in the endgame

The tension in the centre is increased. Playing ...c7-c6 also gains space for Black on the queenside.

13 b5

White is waiting for Black waste time on ...h7-h6 before carrying out his Ne6 plan. The sharper 13 Be3 is the subject of the next game.

13...cxd5 14 cxd5 h6 15 Ne6 Bxe6 16 dxe6 fxe4 17 Nxe4 Nxe4 18 Bxe4 d5 19 Ba3

This is why White played 13 b5.

19...dxe4 20 Qxd8 Rfxd8 21 Bxe7 Re8 22 Bc5 Rxe6 23 Rxe4
(Diagram 11)

At first glance his endgame may look slightly better for White because Black has a central pawn restricting the activity of his bishop. In practice though he has had very little difficulty as his rooks are active and his king can come quickly to the centre.

23...a6! 24 b6 Rc8 25 Be3 Bf6 26 Rd1 Rd8 27 Rb1 Rc6 28 g4 h5 29 Kg2 Kf7 30 Kf3 Ke6 31 Ra4 Rf8 32 Kg2 Rfc8 33 h3 Rc4 34 Rxa6 bxa6 35 b7 Rb8 36 Ba7 Rxb7 37 Rxb7 Ra4 Draw agreed

Game 24

□ Xu Jun ■ Ye Jiangchuan

Shanghai 2001

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Nf3 0-0 6 Be2 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 b4 Nh5 10 Re1 f5 11 Ng5 Nf6! 12 Bf3 c6 13 Be3

This is an attempt to lure Black into playing 13...f4 after which White would calmly return home with 14 Bc1. The move ...f5-f4 takes all the pressure off the centre so White is quite happy to spend two moves to achieve this. Black should now go in for the exchanging sequence that we have already seen in the previous game.

13...cxd5 14 cxd5 h6 15 Ne6 Bxe6 16 dxe6 fxe4 17 Nxe4 Nxe4 18 Bxe4 d5 (Diagram 12)

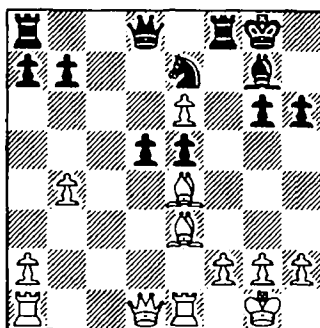


Diagram 12

A dynamically equal position

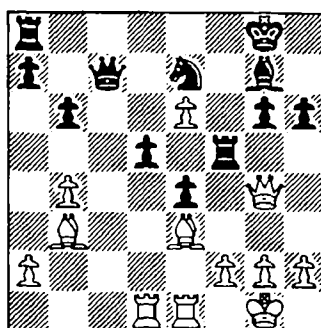


Diagram 13

Black consolidates his defences

19 Bc2

19 Bc5 dxe4 20 Qxd8 Rfxd8 21 Bxe7 leads to the same ending as before, the only difference that the white pawn is on b4 instead of b5.

19...b6

Black must stop White from playing Bc5.

White has two active bishops, a safer king and a passed pawn on e6, which although likely to die, may seriously annoy Black in the process. In Black's favour is his strong centre and the fact that he is likely to emerge a pawn ahead. He must tread very carefully, though, as it will be easy to have a tactical accident as White's rooks and bishops pile pressure on the centre.

20 Qg4 e4!

Black will now make his presence felt on the dark squares. Black went through a lot of suffering before he found this move.

21 Rad1 Qc7 22 Bb3 Rf5! (Diagram 13)

An excellent move which defends the pawn on d5, prepares to double rooks on the f-file and cuts communications between the queen and the pawn on e6. What more could you ask? Practice has shown that White can only hope for equality in this position.

23 Rd2 Qc3

Black should avoid 23...Bc3 24 Rc1 but the new FIDE World Champion, 18 year old Ruslan Ponomarev, has played 23...Raf8.

24 Qd1 Rd8 25 b5 Qc8 26 Bd4 Bxd4 27 Rxd4 Qc5

Black can't play 27...Qxe6 because of 28 Rdx4!.



NOTE: In this line Black should always make sure, before capturing on e6, that White doesn't have such a tactic.

28 Re2 Rdf8 29 a4 Re5 30 h3 Draw agreed

Game 25

□ Quinn ■ Shirov

European Team Championship, Leon 2001

1 Nf3 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 d4 0-0 6 Be2 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 b4 Nh5 10 Re1 f5 11 Ng5 Nf6 12 f3

In the previous games White defended his centre with 12 Bf3 but this ultimately led to its destruction. This time White prefers to defend his centre more solidly with a pawn.

12...Nh5!? (Diagram 14)

This is the very latest stuff. Black only went back to f6 last move because White was threatening to play Bxh5. Now that this is no longer possible Black cheekily returns to h5.

13 g3

White decides that ...Nf4 is a threat and prevents it. He has also tried 13 c5 and 13 Kh1 but without success. However, this line is still in its

infancy and I would expect White to soon come fighting back with new ideas.

13...Bf6!

Black wants to force Ne6 and this is much stronger than 13...h6 as the g7-square is vacated for the knight on h5.

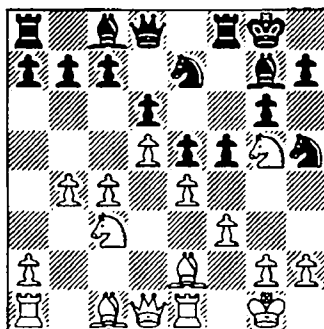


Diagram 14
The knight returns to h5!

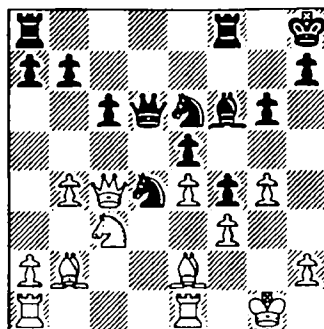


Diagram 15
Black is a pawn up for nothing

14 Ne6 Bxe6 15 dxe6 f4

This keeps the centre closed and seriously reduces the threat from the white bishops.

16 g4 Ng7 17 Qb3?

After this move there is no hope for White as when a black knight lands on d4 it is going to be with tempo. If he had played 17 c5 he might have got some compensation for the pawn he is going to lose.

17...Nc6 18 c5 Kh8 19 Bb2 Nd4 20 Qd5 Ngxe6 21 cxd6 c6!

Now White doesn't even get control over d5.

22 Qc4 Qxd6 (Diagram 15) 23 b5 Rac8 24 bxc6 Rxc6 25 Qd3 Nxe2+ 26 Qxe2 Rxc3! White resigns

White gives up the ghost as 27 Bxc3+ is met by 27...Qc5+ followed by 28...Qxc3.

White Plays 9 Nd2

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Nf3 0-0 6 Be2 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 Nd2 (Diagram 16)

Until 9 b4 took over in the mid-1990's this had become the most popular variation in the Classical King's Indian. Most of the world's top players took one side or another in a long running theoretical debate. Then, almost overnight, it all went quiet. That doesn't mean it won't be back so it remains an extremely important variation.